

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

TIPS

EXCEL 2007—General Tips	61
Excel Formulas	66
OBVIOUS: Getting the best out of it!	68

30 MINUTES EXPERT

Windows Scripting Host	64
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EXCEL 2007—GENERAL TIPS

This is a selection of general tips for Excel 2007 which most of you will find useful. Many of these apply to earlier versions of Excel as well.

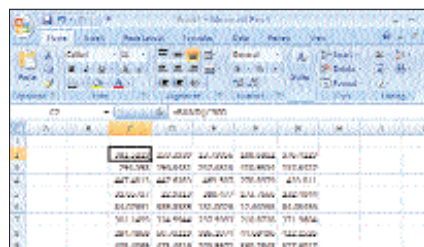
Random Numbers

At times, we need to generate random numbers to simulate a scenario. It can get a little irritating to keep on typing random digits all the time. To generate a random number, use the RAND() command.

For example, to generate a number between 0 and 500, type:

=RAND()*500

Similarly, randomly generating

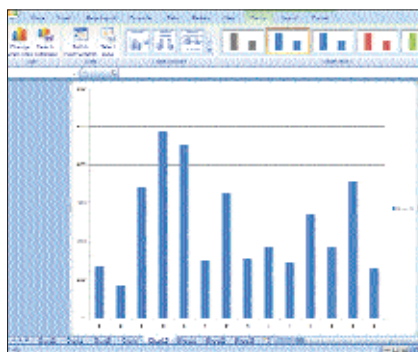


Random numbers for multiple cells

numbers between any two numbers can be done using RANDBETWEEN(). For example:
=RANDBETWEEN(50,100)
will generate numbers between 50 and 100.

Quick Graph

One expects to go through a dozen steps in a Wizard to make a graph. Assuming that the graph data is



Graph creation is a single key-press process

basic, simply pressing [F11] will create a graph with the selected cells instantaneously. That's not all! In case you don't like the graph that's been created for you because it's chosen the wrong fields or the style doesn't suite it, you can right-click on the graph and change the graph type or the cells selected.

Insert The Current Date And Time

This can be done using shortcuts. Pressing [Ctrl] + [;] will add the date; pressing [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [;] will add the time.

Quick-sort Data

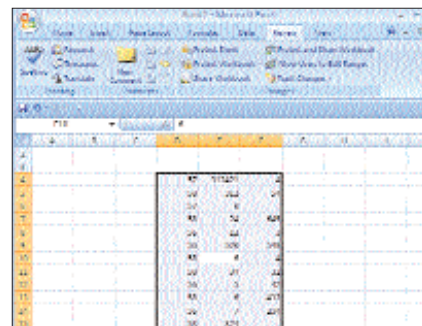
If you end up creating a huge table filled with tons of data and want to easily sort the data according to a certain column or row, select the cells that you want to sort. Then, click on the Data ribbon and click Sort. You will then be shown a Sort window where you can choose the columns you would like to sort by.

The Quick Access Toolbar

This is a toolbar that can be enabled by right-clicking on the Ribbon and choosing Show Quick Access Toolbar Below the Ribbon. This toolbar is a space where you can choose to place your most commonly-used tools. To add a certain button to the Quick Access Toolbar, right-click on the particular feature and choose Add to Quick Access Toolbar.

Navigate Through Tables

Assume you have a big table of data on a worksheet and you want to easily move through it without going beyond its boundaries. Here's a way to do that: first you select the region of cells you want to set as the table. Press [Enter] to move vertically downwards. Pressing [Shift] + [Enter] will let you move vertically upwards.



Limit movement within a highlighted selection

Similarly, [Tab] will move horizontally across to the right, and [Shift] + [Tab] will do the opposite: move to the left.

Moving to and from to each extreme end of the table—the corners—can be done by pressing the [Ctrl] + [.]

Replicate Worksheets

There may be cases where a copy of an existing worksheet is required as a blueprint to work on; you can make a copy of it by pressing [Ctrl] and left-clicking on it and dragging it to the location where you need it.

Delete Blank Rows

Blank rows make their way into spreadsheets whether we like it or not. Sometimes it could be because of missing information. The quickest way to delete blank rows is to highlight the cells and click on the Sort button. All the blank spaces are removed leaving only rows with data on them in the table. Turn off this option to save memory.

Formatting Cells

Very often, users come to a point where their values take a different form. Usually, the formatting is at fault. It could be decimals or the format used to